

Warm-Up: Convention Scavenger Hunt

Discuss:

- What surprised you most from testing your paper prototype?
- What did users struggle with that you didn't anticipate?
- Be ready to share one insight that changed your design

Prayer

Peter, will you pray for us today?

Unit B: Make It Better App

AI can help you explore ideas fast, but it lacks intuition and taste

Today

- Testing Debrief
- AI Tools for Prototyping
- Figma Prototyping Demo
- Work Session (B3 Digital Prototype)

By the end of today...

AI Tools

You'll know the current landscape of AI prototyping tools and what each is good (and bad) at

Digital prototyping

You'll start translating your paper prototype into an interactive digital prototype in Figma

AI Policy

You'll understand the B3/B4 AI policy: AI is welcome for B3, but B4 must be your own Figma work

AI Tools for Prototyping

The good, the bad, and the ugly

Design is the forming and rendering of intent

- AI is a rendering tool, not a forming tool.
- AI can't form intent
- AI can't decide what problem to solve, how to change a design based on prototype testing, etc.

You must put in the work to form your intent.

AI Prototyping/Coding Tools

An non-exhaustive list

Figma Make

AI built into Figma; generates UI from text prompts within your existing file

V0 by Vercel

Generates React-based UIs from text or image input; free tier; produces running code

Lovable

Chat-based full-stack prototype builder; iterate in real time with a live running prototype

Play

iOS-specific; real native elements and Core Animation; exports to SwiftUI/Xcode; free education program

Articulating your intent is key

Let's try an experiment

1. Go to Figma Make
2. Describe an app you want to make, keep it simple
 - a. Create a reminder/to-do app
 - b. Create a calendar app
 - c. Create a library app
3. Submit your prompt

Raise your hand when Figma Make has finished making your app. Tell me about your results.

Writing better prompts

1. Go to Claude.ai
2. Write a prompt like this: “I want you to help me write a prompt for Figma Make. I’m designing a [insert the same app idea as before]. Before writing the prompt, please ask me clarifying questions to gather whatever information you need to write a detailed prompt for Figma Make. I also have a reference image to include. Please ask for that when you’re ready for it.
3. Answer whatever questions Claude asks of you.
4. Take the prompt Claude gives you to Figma Make. Include your reference image. (I’ve added some reference images to the Unit B: Make It Better Figjam file.

Raise your hand when Figma Make has finished making your app. Tell me about your results.

AI Limitations

1. Doesn't always follow conventions
2. It will make stuff up to fill in gaps and to attempt to please you
3. It doesn't always match your style
4. It will change things that you didn't want changed

AI is like an over-eager junior designer and engineer. The clearer your instructions, the better the output it gives you.

What are you noticing in the prototype it made for you?

AI Policy for B3 and B4

B3 (Digital Prototype)

You may use AI tools freely — Figma Make, v0, Lovable, Play, etc.

B4 (Final High-Fidelity)

Must be designed in Figma without AI tools.

B3 is where you learn what AI can do.

B4 is where you prove what you can do.

Figma Prototyping

- Your final prototype needs to be made using Figma's prototyping tools
- Let's do a quick demo

Next up

- B3 Digital Prototype: Translate your tested paper prototype into an interactive Figma prototype
 - Match the existing app's design language (typography, spacing, color, interaction patterns)
 - Try Figma Make, v0, or Lovable — or build from scratch in Figma
 - If designing for iOS, explore Play for native-feeling prototypes
- User Testing (Round 2): Test with at least 2 people (not classmates) — can happen after class
- If you used an AI tool: Check every screen against your paper prototype and platform conventions

Don't forget about the iOS and Material Design resources files!